

Making PPT Slides for Scientific Presentations

Instructions

- Presentation in pairs
- Approx. 20 min presentation + Q&A/debate
 - 10 min / student
 - **Cannot read!**
 - Prepare notes on cards
 - Practice, practice, practice
- 20% of final grade; individual mark
- 10-15 slides

How to prepare

- Develop a scientific question (*“problématique”*)
- **Research** and read several articles
 - Use **recent** articles/sources
- Prepare **PPT & handouts**
- Include a **diagram, table, image ...**
- OPTIONAL: quiz afterwards (wooclap, Kahoot, etc.)
- Practice, practice, practice: **No reading**

The PPT musts/ must not

MUST HAVE

- Title page
- Research question
- Outline / plan of presentation
- Tables, graphs, diagrams (referenced)
- Scientific bibliography

MUST NOT

- Sentences/too many words
- Spelling errors

Outline of presentation plan

Title page (1 slide)

Plan of the PPT (1 slide)

Introduction + background (2-3 slides)

Development (4-8 slides)

Conclusion (2-3 slides)

Thank you

Bibliography

OPTIONAL: 2 questions for the class / Quiz (wooclap, Kahoot, ...)

Structure: Beginning

- Have a “**sexy**” opening:
 - Interesting fact; ask a question; tell a story
- Explain presentation outline and follow it!
- Start with the big picture + **scientific question**
 - Give some background (history, past experiments, current situation, problem(s)...)

Structure: Development

Development: answer your scientific question

- Discuss the relevant issues to the topic
- Develop different aspects
- Include different perspectives to illustrate critical thinking
- Suggest possible experiments or solutions

Structure: Conclusion

Use an effective and strong closing

- Your audience will remember your last words

Conclusion slide(s):

1. **Summarize** the main points
2. **Suggest** future avenues of research

End with a “thank you” slide

- NOT “thanks you”
- NOT “Thanks”

Ask your audience for questions

Bibliography

- You must have several **scientific sources**
- **4-5 sources NOT older than 2018 + 1 source from 2023-2026**
- **Wikipedia** is **NOT** a scientific source. It can be referenced once.
- Ensure the sources are **correctly referenced**

Handouts

1 Glossary of technical words

- Minimum 5-10 words
- Use simple definitions in **English**
- Give source of definition *Ex. Merriam Webster Dictionary*

2 Abstract of your presentation

- Write a short summary of your presentation
- 5-6 lines

3 Bibliography

Bring handouts for everyone

Spelling and Grammar

- **Proofread** your slides for:
 - spelling mistakes
 - repeated words
 - grammatical errors
- Ask someone else to check your English

Slide Tips

- Include 3-5 points per slide
- Use key words and phrases only
 - **No complete sentences**
- 1-2 slides / minute (5-10 slides)
- Use titles: slides, diagrams

Slide Tips

- Use colour to reinforce the logic of your structure (**title** vs text)
- Use big fonts: can the people at the back read it?
- Use different sizes:
 - big for main points
 - smaller for secondary points

Speaking tips

- Talk to your audience, not the slide and **not your professor**
- Don't read the PPT
- Don't read notes. **You lose 10 points**
- Don't be monotone
- Leave time for Q & A.

Speaking tips

- Make eye contact with EVERYONE
- Don't cross your arms/hands in pockets
- Be dynamic and move!

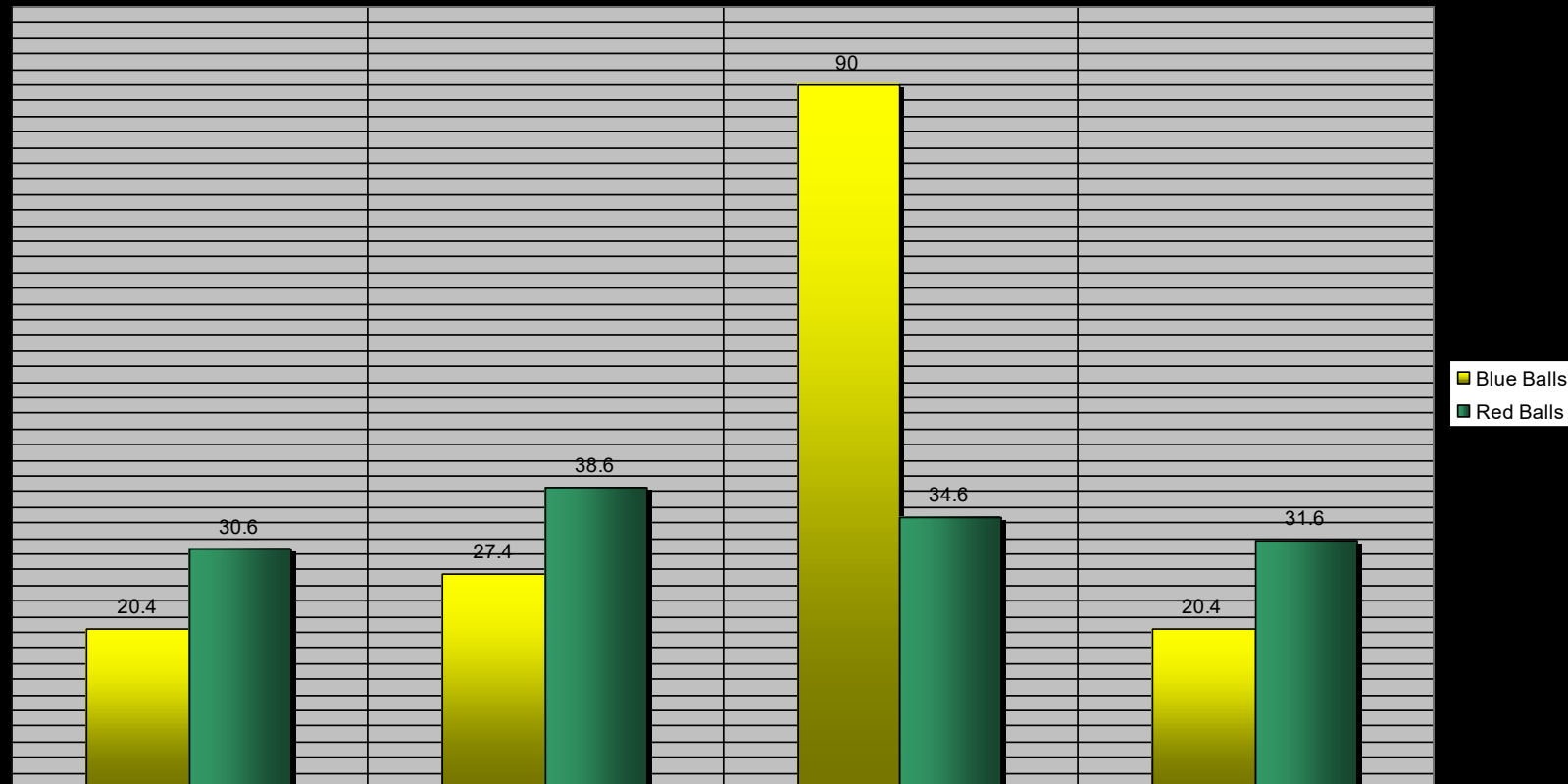
Chilean Exports

- Fresh fruit leads Chile's export mix - Chile emerges as major supplier of fresh fruit to world market due to ample natural resources, consumer demand for fresh fruit during winter season in U.S. and Europe, and incentives in agricultural policies of Chilean government, encouraging trend toward diversification of exports and development of nontraditional crops - U.S. Dept. of Agriculture, Economic Research Service Report
- Chile is among the developing economies taking advantage of these trends, pursuing a free market economy. This has allowed for diversification through the expansion of fruit production for export, especially to the U.S. and Western Europe. Chile has successfully diversified its agricultural sector to the extent that it is now a major fruit exporting nation. Many countries view Chile's diversification of agriculture as a model to be followed.
- Meanwhile, the U.S. remains the largest single market for Chile's fruit exports. However, increasing demand from the EC and Central and East European countries combined may eventually surpass exports to the U.S., spurring further growth in Chile's exports.
- If you've read this far, your eyes probably hurt and you've been reading this tedious long-winded text instead of listening to me. I'm insulted- can't you see I'm doing a presentation up here? Look at me! Congratulations, however, on having such good eyesight.

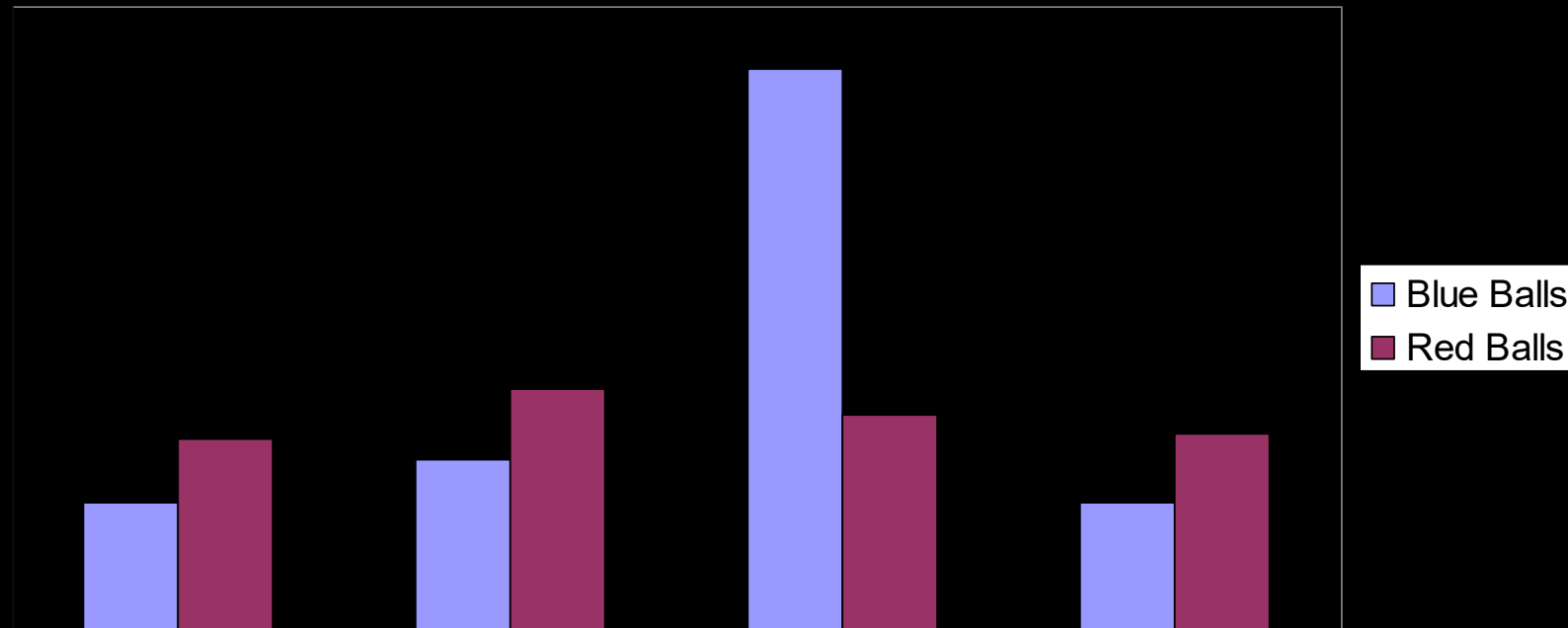
Slide Structure - BAD

- This page contains too many words for a presentation slide. It is not written in point form, making it difficult both for your audience to read and for you to present each point. Although there are exactly the same number of points on this slide as the previous slide, it looks much more complicated. In short, your audience will spend too much time trying to read this paragraph instead of listening to you.

Graphs



Graphs



Background

- Avoid backgrounds that are distracting or difficult to read from
- Always be consistent with the background that you use



Colour

- Using a font colour that does not contrast with the background colour is hard to read
- Using colour for decoration is **distracting** and **annoying**.
- Using a different colour for each point is unnecessary
 - Using a different colour for secondary points is also unnecessary
- **Trying to be creative can also be bad**